Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report on

Five Oaks

Abergavenny

Date Inspection Completed

14/06/2023

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About Five Oaks

Type of care provided	Care Home Service Adults and Children Without Nursing
Registered Provider	Five Oaks Care Ltd
Registered places	6
Language of the service	English
Previous Care Inspectorate Wales inspection	11 May 2022
Does this service provide the Welsh Language active offer?	This service does not provide an 'Active Offer' of the Welsh language and does not demonstrate a significant effort to promoting the use of the Welsh language and culture.

Summary

Well-being

People can do things that matter to them and that they enjoy. Care workers build relationships with people by spending time with them, seeking their views and preferences on an ongoing basis. Staff cater for people's preferences, are able to anticipate their needs, and interprete non-verbal communication as required. People can choose what to do and where to spend their time. Visits from relatives and friends take place, and for those who require it, visits to family members at their home, are organised. The service strives to ensure people have as much choice and control over their daily lives as possible.

People are supported to remain as independent and as healthy as possible. Stimulating activities and good relationships with care staff help to support people's emotional health. Appointments with health and social care professionals are arranged for regular checks or if individual needs change.

People are protected from abuse and neglect as care staff know what to look out for and how to raise concerns if they suspect someone's well-being is compromised. Care staff are trained in safeguarding and have clear policies and procedures to guide them. Well-established protocols protect people from having their freedom restricted unnecessarily, and detailed risk management plans help to keep people safe and as independent as possible.

The accommodation provides people with a spacious, comfortable environment. The service is clean, warm and welcoming. Bedrooms reflect individuality and clearly represent individual peferences. The service is set in a quiet and tranquil rural area with access to safe outside spaces. Equipment is in place to support people to enjoy their time spent outdoors. There is a small maintenance team employed who undertake regular maintenance checks.

Care and Support

People appear content. Staff are kind and caring and provide individual support detailed in personal plans. Staff demonstrate a clear understanding of individual needs. There is choice including about activities, menu options and daily routines. Care staff know people well and how they like their support to be provided and strive to deliver support to people in the way which matters most to them. Personal plans are comprehensive and detailed and guide care workers about the support required by the individual. The outcomes people wish to achieve are recorded. Personal plans are updated when changes are identified. Although informal reviews of personal plans take place regularly and are documented, the service needs to clearly reflect formal reviews have taken place. Feedback from people using the service, where possible, and their representatives should be recorded as part of the review process. This would ensure the service has a clearer audit trail of identified changes and decision-making. Feedback from peoples' relatives is positive. One person told us *"The service is first class".* Another stated *"X loves it there; they go above and beyond"*.

People receive support as identified in their personal plans. Daily care recordings completed by care workers give a detailed overview about the support provided. People are encouraged to be as independent and healthy as possible. People have access to arrange of activities which helps to enhance their feelings of well-being. The service regularly engages with other health and social care professionals as required. The service takes a pro-active approach in order to ensure people remain as healthy as possible.

Staff ensure people are as safe as possible by adhering to clear policies and procedures and take swift action when needed. Records show management deals promptly and appropriately with incidents affecting people's well-being. Detailed and comprehensive risk assessments are compiled and adhered to. Steps to ensure any restrictions placed on a person's liberty are only in their best interests are taken. Written information about people's capacity to make decisions, decisions made in their best interests and deprivation of liberty safeguards applications are stored appropriately.

Medication systems are in place and have been recently enhanced. This demonstrates the service places high regard to ensuring the ongoing improvement and development of medication is in place. Medication is securely stored and is only accessible to staff who have the training and knowledge to administer medication. Medication administration records (MAR) are available at the service and staff routinely sign when medication is given. All MAR charts contain a photograph of the people living at the service in order to reduce the likelihood of medication being given to the wrong person. Written comprehensive monthly audits of medication which consider the effectiveness of the current arrangements are not available. Completion of regular medication audits would assist the provider to identify and make further changes if required. There is a medication policy

available, but this is basic and does not provide sufficient information to support the service. We were provided with assurances this will be addressed.

Environment

The environment helps to support people to achieve their personal outcomes. The service is located over two sites close to one another. Both sites are welcoming, and entrances are secure. Our identity and reason for our visit was checked prior to admission. People live in spacious accommodation and are supported to spend time communally and privately. People's bedrooms reflect their taste and interests. The service is set in a quiet, peaceful, rural location with access to pleasant outside spaces.

Arrangements are in place to ensure risks to people's health and safety are identified and dealt with. Checks are conducted which identify and address issues. The service has access to a small team of maintenance staff. There are arrangements in place for ensuring maintenance issues are reported and dealt with. The recommendations identified following a recent Fire Officer's report have been completed. Individuals living at the service have appropriate personal emergency evacuation plans (PEEP) in place and these have been reviewed and updated. Copies of PEEPs are easily accessible in a separate file should these be required in the event of an emergency. There is appropriate oversight regarding electricity safety checks and portable application testing (PAT). Both sites have had new gas boilers installed within the last year and servicing of these were not due at the time of the inspection. An up-to-date fire risk assessment is in place, and there is documentation which confirms fire drills are carried out at appropriate intervals.

Leadership and Management

People are provided with accurate information about the service. There is a statement of purpose (SOP) which describes how the service is provided. This helps to support people to choose a service which is able to meet their needs. The statement of purpose reflects the service being provided.

The provider has systems in place which help identify areas where the service needs to develop and improve. The manager completes a range of information regarding quality assurance which demonstrate their ongoing oversight of the daily management of the service. Regular team meetings take place and feedback from these meetings help the service to identify areas where they need to further develop. The most recent quality of care review report was provided to us at the time of the inspection. The provider considers how well the service is able to meet people's well-being outcomes. The provider visits regularly to oversee progress and developments and to complete checks. Reports completed on a three-monthly basis reflect what is working well and identifies areas for further development.

People are supported by staff who are trained, valued and developed. The provider conducts the necessary checks when recruiting staff. New staff receive an induction in line with the requirements of the social care workforce regulator Social Care Wales (SCW). Most staff are fully registered with SCW as members of the social care workforce. Some newly recruited staff members are working towards their registration. Staff receive an extensive training programme relevant to their roles and refresher training is available. Individualised supervision is provided to staff at regular intervals in line with regulation, and annual appraisals take place. Staff are complementary about working at the service, are happy in their roles and feel appropriately supported. One care worker told us *"I love my job".* Another stated "*I feel valued, the manager is approachable and listens*".

The service provider ensures the leadership and management arrangements in place, supports the smooth and effective operation of the service.The manager is experienced and has worked at the service for some years. They know people well and demonstrate commitment to providing a good quality service. They ensure effective day-to-day management and oversight of the service takes place.

Summary of Non-Compliance	
Status	**What each means**
New	This non-compliance was identified at this inspection.
Reviewed	Compliance was reviewed at this inspection and was not achieved. The target date for compliance is in the future and will be tested at next inspection.
Not Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was not achieved.
Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was achieved.

We respond to non-compliance with regulations where poor outcomes for people, and / or risk to people's well-being are identified by issuing Priority Action Notice (s).

The provider must take immediate steps to address this and make improvements. Where providers fail to take priority action by the target date we may escalate the matter to an Improvement and Enforcement Panel.

Priority Action Notice(s)		
Regulation	Summary	Status
N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

Where we find non-compliance with regulations but no immediate or significant risk for people using the service is identified we highlight these as Areas for Improvement.

We expect the provider to take action to rectify this and we will follow this up at the next inspection. Where the provider has failed to make the necessary improvements we will escalate the matter by issuing a Priority Action Notice.

Area(s) for Improvement		
Regulation	Summary	Status

N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

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